

THE "NINE BEAT EXERCISE"

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #150

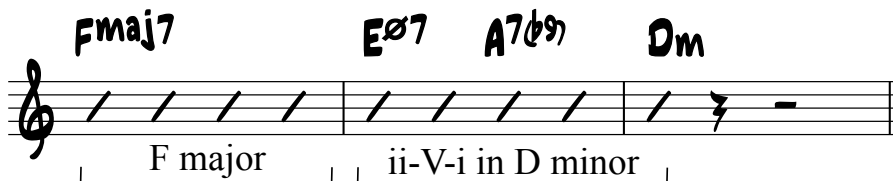
Playing "inside the changes" is one of the huge goals of anyone who improvises jazz on a melodic instrument. Whether you solo on bass or trumpet, sax or guitar, your job is to create a melody that has a lot of harmonic information in it. In most great bebop solos, we can *hear* the harmony inside the melody, even with no bass line or chord changes present.

Getting better at almost any aspect of our playing is all about practicing with *focus*. The more we focus on an area in our practice, the better it gets. The Nine Beat Exercise is all about creating some serious focus on the harmonic content of our melodies.

#1 - Confirmation (Charlie Parker)



#2 - A "Nine Beat" area of the chord changes



The goal is to pick a place in the tune where the harmony moves from one key to another.

#3 - A "bad" version



Here, every note is great relative to the chord, yet there is no harmonic shape to it. BAD!

#4 - A "good" version



Here, every note is great relative to the chord, and there is strong harmonic shape to it. GOOD!